

JARVIS V5

Tools Edition

Your AI second brain now has a voice and hands. It talks with you, remembers your notes, reads your calendar and email, drafts replies, and connects to the apps you already use. Everything runs locally, on your machine, with your keys. This guide takes you from zip file to a working JARVIS in about ten minutes.

10

MINUTE
SETUP

1

REQUIRED
KEY

2

PLATFORMS, MAC +
WIN

0

CODE
REQUIRED

How this works

JARVIS is a small server that lives in one folder on your computer. You start it with a double click, open Chrome, and talk. Your notes become a 3D galaxy he answers from, and the Tool Armory gives him real hands: calendars, email drafts, design tools, code repos. Nothing runs in a cloud you do not control. Your API keys sit in one local file that never leaves your machine.

What you need

ITEM	WHERE	NOTES
Python 3	Built into macOS · python.org on Windows	On Windows, tick “Add python.exe to PATH” during install
Google Chrome	google.com/chrome	Needed for the microphone and voice
Anthropic API key	console.anthropic.com	The only required key. Add a few dollars of credit
Optional: ElevenLabs key	elevenlabs.io	Cinematic voice. The free browser voice works out of the box
Optional: OpenRouter key	openrouter.ai	One key unlocks Grok, GPT, Gemini brain swaps
Optional: Zapier account	zapier.com	One of several ways to bridge everyday apps. Not required

Install

On Mac

1. Unzip the Mac zip anywhere, Documents is perfect.
2. Duplicate `config.example.json` and rename the copy to `config.json`.
3. Open `config.json` in any editor and paste your Anthropic key over `PUT-YOUR-MODEL-API-KEY-HERE`.
4. Double click `start-jarvis.command`. First time only: right click, choose Open, then Open again. Leave the window running.
5. In Chrome, open `http://localhost:4719` and say hi.

On Windows

1. Install Python 3 from python.org and tick “Add python.exe to PATH”.
2. Unzip the Windows zip anywhere.
3. Copy `config.example.json` to `config.json` and paste your Anthropic key.
4. Double click `START-JARVIS.bat` and leave the black window open. If SmartScreen warns you, choose More info, then Run anyway.
5. In Chrome, open `http://localhost:4719` and say hi.

Windows note: voice, tools, brain swaps, research, reminders and languages all work. A few Mac extras, like the desktop orb and Mac control commands, simply stay off.

Giving JARVIS hands

Click the plug button at the bottom of the page. This is the armory: every app JARVIS can reach, laid out as tiles. Connect one and he uses it mid conversation, with a receipt under every answer naming exactly which tool ran. If something is not connected, he says so honestly instead of inventing an answer.

Two ways to add tools

- 1. **One click tiles.** Canva, Notion, GitHub, Figma, Airtable, Webflow and more. Click the tile, sign in on the official page that opens, done.
- 2. **Bring your own MCP server.** Click *Add your own tool*, give it a name, and paste any MCP server URL. JARVIS probes it, handles the sign in if one is needed, and shelves it like any other tile. Any service that publishes an MCP endpoint works, and more appear every week.

Bridging everyday apps

Email and calendar providers mostly do not publish their own MCP endpoints yet. Any MCP bridge service fills that gap. Zapier is one popular option: a free account at `mcp.zapier.com` lets you create your own MCP server, choose which apps and actions it exposes, and paste its URL into the armory like any other tool. Similar bridges work the same way. This is optional. JARVIS is fully useful without it.

Safety habit worth keeping: when you expose email actions through any bridge, choose Create Draft rather than Send. JARVIS writes the draft, you press send.

Say these first

YOU SAY	WHAT HAPPENS
“What’s on my calendar tomorrow?”	Your real agenda, read back with one dry remark
“Check my email”	Primary inbox highlights, spoken aloud
“Draft a reply to the last email from...”	A real draft lands in your drafts folder
“That’s okay, get back to me when it’s done”	He works silently and reports once at the end
“Check again”	Re-runs the last tool question fresh

The V5 feature map

Brain hot swap. “Try on sonnet, haiku, fable” by voice. With OpenRouter: grok, gpt, gemini, deepseek. “Back to default” any time.

Instant interrupt. Talk over him and he pauses in a fraction of a second. A cough hands his voice back.

Live web research. “Research the latest AI news” searches the live web and shows sources on screen.

Living notes. “Remember that...” and “create a project for...” write real markdown files and grow the galaxy on the spot.

Your own vault. Point `config.json` at your Obsidian folder, run `build.py`, and the galaxy becomes your notes.

Screen sight. Share your screen with the monitor button and ask about what you are looking at. He sees it, answers, and can research it on the spot.

Tasks and briefings. Reminders, a morning briefing, and a persistent inbox of cards that need you.

Sixteen languages. “Speak Spanish” and the whole assistant follows, same voice.

Personas and dials. “Be less funny.” “Go full GLaDOS.” Humor and honesty sliders.

Missions. With the Claude Code CLI installed: a three agent research fleet, or “build me an app” that ships a working page.

Install it, connect one tool, and post your favorite JARVIS answer in the community. The wild ones get featured.

When something misbehaves

SYMPTOM

FIX

Page will not load	The server window closed. Double click the start file again
“python is not recognized” on Windows	Reinstall Python with “Add python.exe to PATH” ticked
Mic blocked	Click the padlock in Chrome’s address bar and allow the microphone
Plain voice	Normal. The browser voice is the free default; an ElevenLabs key upgrades it
A tool answer times out	Say “check again” and he re-runs it fresh
Stale page after an update	Hard reload: Cmd Shift R on Mac, Ctrl Shift R on Windows

A connected tool suddenly stopped working

This is almost never broken code. Walk this list in order:

- 1. Say “check again.”** Slow patches on the wires happen; a fresh run fixes most of them.
- 2. Check your bridge credits.** Bridge services meter usage. On Zapier, open your usage page: each JARVIS tool call spends about two tasks, and when the plan runs out every call quietly fails or comes back empty. Worked this morning, dead this afternoon? This is the culprit nine times out of ten.
- 3. Look at the tile in the armory.** Does it still say connected, or is it paused? Click it and check. If the provider regenerated your server URL, paste the new one into the tile.
- 4. Check the actions on the bridge side.** If you ask for email but never exposed an email action on your bridge server, JARVIS will tell you honestly that it is not connected. Add the app and its actions in the bridge dashboard, then ask again.
- 5. Restart and hard reload.** Close the server window, start it again, and hard reload the Chrome tab.

The receipt under every answer is your friend: it names exactly which tool ran. No receipt means no tool call happened, which points at connection or credits, not at the tool itself.

The last resort that almost always works

You have an AI coding assistant. Use it. Take a screenshot of the error (or copy the text from the server window), open Claude Code inside your `brain-jarvis` folder, paste the screenshot in, and say: “JARVIS is not working. Here is the error. Read this folder and fix it.” It reads the code, finds the problem, and usually repairs it in one pass. This is exactly how the tool was built, and it is the fastest support desk you will ever have.